

5.4.4 Spam Control

Outlook 2003 has a junk e-mail filter that works pretty well. There are two aspects to the spam filter—first, it can treat e-mail as spam based on criteria that you specify; second, it can read your messages and based on words it finds in the message, decide whether a message is spam or not.

You can also set Outlook's 'sensitivity' to the spam it detects—basically, if you set the sensitivity to 'high', more mails will get detected as spam. Outlook's spam filter also learns with experience, and gets better and better at filtering junk e-mail. Here, we take a look at how you can tell Outlook what e-mails are to be treated as junk.



The 'low' setting is the default for junk e-mail. It's also the most recommended

Go to **Actions > Junk E-mail > Junk E-mail Options**. This opens up the 'Junk E-mail Options' dialog box, shown below.

The following are the elements in the Options tab:

1. "No Automatic Filtering" just turns the filter off.
2. "Low" is the default. As mentioned earlier, when the sensitivity is set to low, fewer mails are caught as junk.
3. "High": Use this setting if you receive too many junk mails. However, since this traps more mails as junk, it's likely that some useful mails may get caught as well. So, if you choose this option, remember to check the junk e-mail folder often for good mail.